

1 ENGROSSED HOUSE
2 BILL NO. 3975

By: Caldwell (Trey), Hill, and
Staires of the House

3 and

4 Hall of the Senate
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8 An Act relating to the State Department of Health;
9 creating the Oklahoma Rural Health Transformation
10 Program; stating purpose; designating the State
11 Department of Health as lead agency; allowing for the
12 Department to partner with other agencies; creating
13 reporting requirements; creating the Oklahoma Rural
14 Health Transformation Revolving Fund; establishing
fund at the State Department of Health; deeming the
funds appropriated; providing expenditure and
budgeting requirements and limitations; allowing for
use of memoranda of understanding; limiting scope of
such memoranda; providing for codification; and
declaring an emergency.

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17 BE IT ENACTED BY THE PEOPLE OF THE STATE OF OKLAHOMA:

18 SECTION 1. NEW LAW A new section of law to be codified
19 in the Oklahoma Statutes as Section 3321 of Title 63, unless there
20 is created a duplication in numbering, reads as follows:

21 This act shall be known and may be cited as the "Oklahoma Rural
22 Health Transformation Program (ORHT)".
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1 SECTION 2. NEW LAW A new section of law to be codified
2 in the Oklahoma Statutes as Section 3321.1 of Title 63, unless there
3 is created a duplication in numbering, reads as follows:

4 The purpose of this act is to ensure the oversight of federal
5 funds received by the State Department of Health, and other partner
6 agencies, through the Rural Health Transformation (RHT) Program,
7 created in Public Law No. 119-21.

8 SECTION 3. NEW LAW A new section of law to be codified
9 in the Oklahoma Statutes as Section 3321.2 of Title 63, unless there
10 is created a duplication in numbering, reads as follows:

11 A. The State Department of Health shall act as the lead agency
12 for Oklahoma in handling the Rural Health Transformation (RHT)
13 Program. The Department shall interface with the federal government
14 on behalf of the State of Oklahoma, and other state agencies, in the
15 disbursement of funds, and reporting requirements to the federal
16 government.

17 B. As the lead agency, the State Department of Health shall
18 provide a yearly report on the progress of the expenditures,
19 programs, and outcomes that were listed in the application to the
20 Centers for Medicare and Medicaid Services (CMS), as well as any
21 changes that have been adopted, along with the reasons for such
22 changes. Said report shall be submitted annually no later than
23 January 31 throughout the life of the program. Such reports shall
24 be submitted to the Governor, the Speaker of the Oklahoma House of

1 Representatives, the President Pro Tempore of the Oklahoma State
2 Senate, the Appropriations and Budget Chair of the Oklahoma House of
3 Representatives, the Appropriations Chair of the Oklahoma State
4 Senate, and the relevant subcommittee chairs for each chamber.
5 Additionally, the Department shall publish such reports on its
6 website.

7 C. No less than quarterly the Department shall publish on its
8 website progress reports for all projects, including the expenditure
9 of funds for each project as of the latest completed calendar
10 quarter.

11 SECTION 4. NEW LAW A new section of law to be codified
12 in the Oklahoma Statutes as Section 3321.3 of Title 63, unless there
13 is created a duplication in numbering, reads as follows:

14 A. There is hereby created in the State Treasury a revolving
15 fund for the State Department of Health to be designated the
16 "Oklahoma Rural Health Transformation Revolving Fund (ORHT Revolving
17 Fund)". The fund shall be a continuing fund, not subject to fiscal
18 year limitations, and shall consist of all monies received by the
19 State Department of Health for the benefit of the Rural Health
20 Transformation (RHT) Program overseen by the Centers for Medicare
21 and Medicaid Services (CMS). All monies accruing to the credit of
22 said fund are hereby appropriated and may be budgeted and expended
23 by the State Department of Health for the purpose of funding
24 programs and projects approved by CMS for the RHT Program.

1 Expenditures from said fund shall be made upon warrants issued by
2 the State Treasurer against claims filed as prescribed by law with
3 the Director of the Office of Management and Enterprise Services for
4 approval and payment.

5 B. The State Department of Health may enter into memoranda of
6 understanding with partner agencies for the expenditure of funds
7 from the ORHT Revolving Fund. Such expenditures are limited to
8 those necessary to complete projects and programs under the RHT
9 Program.

10 SECTION 5. It being immediately necessary for the preservation
11 of the public peace, health or safety, an emergency is hereby
12 declared to exist, by reason whereof this act shall take effect and
13 be in full force from and after its passage and approval.

14 Passed the House of Representatives the 11th day of March, 2026.

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Presiding Officer of the House
of Representatives

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19 Passed the Senate the ____ day of _____, 2026.

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Presiding Officer of the Senate

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